

Laidlaw Progress Brief — Week 2

Recalibrated science; shared next steps

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Second-week update July 2026

*Purpose: share how the 17 July meeting changed the target,
what public layers are ready, and what still needs the team.
No Hospital Authority outcome coefficients are claimed.*

1. Where things stand

The July lab meeting recalibrated the near-term question: the general HA file does not specify reasons for admission, so AMI/principal-dx CVD from that extract is out of scope. We are preparing for **monthly stroke admission aggregates**, with a labelled multi-method panel rather than one hero model.

Public environmental layers for 2013–2023 are now in place (HKO climate and extremes, C&SD denominators, EPD pollution, CHP flu for sensitivity). An analysis panel has been dry-run only on synthetic stroke outcomes to test plumbing. **These are not findings.**

2. Team note

I also need to be clear about process. After our January exchange I went quiet and built HKO files without looping Hogan in; that was a mistake in teamwork, and I am working to repair it. Weather and “hot month” / heatwave definitions should remain a shared conversation — including Hogan’s suggestion to define heatwaves, count them by month, and flag upper-tail months. Roro remains central for aggregates and transfer rules. Dr Bishai’s reminder stands: go far together.

3. Scientific framing

*Monthly thermal exposures and stroke admission aggregates in Hong Kong, 2013–2023:
a multi-specification analysis complementary to daily heatwave–mortality work.*

Cold remains co-primary in the literature. Heatwave definition diversity is intentional. Monthly burden is not interchangeable with daily DLNM or excess-death counts.

4. What is ready / what is open

Ready to use: public climate, pollution, population, and flu layers; transparent pathway panel waiting for real aggregates.

Open: stroke file + dictionary (Roro); hot-month / heatwave operationalisation with Hogan; Gate 3 headline freeze with the team after real descriptives.

5. Ask

When aggregates are cleared, we run QC and the labelled panel together — and we freeze headline specifications only after shared review.

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